HAIR LOSS 13

Pumpkin seed oil

Oil pressed from the seeds of Cucurbita pepo, the common pumpkin



CLASS Plant oil (dietary supplement)

STUDIED FOR Male and female pattern hair loss

HUMAN EVIDENCE Small human studies

US STATUS Dietary supplement

STUDIED FOR

Male pattern loss	Female pattern loss	Prostate symptoms
HUMAN + ANIMAL	HUMAN	HUMAN

Industry-funded trial. The 2014 trial in men tested a branded capsule; capsules, randomization codes and a grant came from its supplier.

HOW IT WORKS IN THE BODY

Pumpkin seed oil → 5α-reductase → Antiandrogen → Hair growth

- **5α-reductase blocking** and antiandrogen effects reported in rats
- **In mice,** oil on the skin raised hair growth scores over 3 weeks
- **In people,** the mechanism is not established; DHT was not measured

EVIDENCE & WHAT'S KNOWN

EVIDENCE

SMALL HUMAN
LEVEL 3 OF 5

- 1 placebo-controlled trial, 76 men
- Hair count +40% vs +10% on placebo
- 1 open trial, 60 women, no placebo

NOT YET ESTABLISHED

- Long-term safety
- Half-life in people
- Effect on DHT in men
- Drug interactions

QUICK PRACTICAL INFO

HALF-LIFE Not established in people

ROUTES STUDIED By mouth (capsules); on the scalp in one trial in women

PHARMACOKINETICS Not established

SOLD AS Dietary supplement

MONITORED IN TRIALS Hair count and thickness, erection questionnaire (IIEF-5)

SPORT (WADA) Not on the 2026 list

REGULATORY

FDA	Not an approved drug; dietary supplement
EMA	Herbal monograph: urinary symptoms, not hair
WADA	Not on the 2026 list

REFERENCES

1. Cho et al., Evid Based Complement Alternat Med, pumpkin seed oil in men, Apr 2014
2. EMA, Community herbal monograph on pumpkin seed, Mar 2013
3. WADA, 2026 Prohibited List

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